

Πολύχαρμος ὁ Ἱστορικός

Polycharmus the Historian on the Lycian Oracle

eul_aid: cfs

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)

Dialect: [Κοινή](#) [Koine](#) (frg)

Domain: [Ἱστορία](#) [History](#)

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Polycharmus the Historian was a Greek author of the 4th–3rd centuries BCE. The epithet "the Historian" distinguishes him from other figures of the same name. No biographical details survive.

His only known work is **On Aphrodite**, preserved solely in a single fragment. The grammarian Athenaeus of Naucratis quotes this fragment in his **Deipnosophistae**. It records that the courtesans of Naucratis in Egypt were the first to establish a temple to Aphrodite.

Polycharmus is a minor, fragmentary historian. His significance lies entirely in this one citation, which provides a specific detail about the cult of Aphrodite and social history in a Hellenistic Greek settlement. His work exemplifies the lost local histories used as sources by later compilers like Athenaeus.

Works (1)

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